

13th Legion

Drill & Ceremony



STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

TEXAS STATE MILITIA

SECTION 1: BASIC DRILL

Introduction

This booklet is designed as a quick reference to the US Army drill procedures most frequently utilized by the Militia. The source reference for Sections 1-5 is US Army Training Circular 3-21.5 (January 2012). The ceremony described in Section 6 follows US Army drill protocols but is specific to the Texas State Militia.

Drill Commands

Most drill movements use a two-part command. The first part of the command is called the *preparatory command*. It alerts the troops to what is coming. The second part of the command is the *command of execution*. There is a one-count pause between the two parts of the command. Upon hearing the command of execution, the militiamen will perform the movement. Militiamen do not move until the command of execution is complete.

Some drill movements use a combined command, where the preparatory command and command of execution are combined. At Ease, Fall In, and Rest are examples of combined commands.

Types of Formations

Most drill is executed from one of two types of formations: the line formation. The line formation consists of one or more ranks of militiamen standing abreast and facing the commander. The column formation consists of one or more files of militiamen standing one behind the other.

The discussion of Fall In (later in this booklet) explains how troops are assembled into a line formation. A line formation may be changed into a column formation by giving the command Right Face.

Line formations are used for accountability, instruction, inspection, and ceremonial purposes.

Terminology

Rank: a line of militiamen standing side by side. militiamen in ranks are in a line formation.

SECTION 2: STATIONARY DRILL MOVEMENTS

Position of Attention

This is the basic position of all drill. There are two commands that call troops to this position: one is *Fall In* (more on this later), and the other is *Attention*.

On the command of *Attention*, the militiamen will:

- a. Stand with heels together, feet spread at a 45-degree angle;
- b. Legs are straight, but knees not locked;
- c. The belly is pulled in, the chest is out, and the shoulders are square;
- d. The arms hang naturally by the side;
- e. The hands are cupped, thumb is aligned alongside the first joint of the index finger, and the sides of the thumb are pressed against the side seams of the pant legs;
- f. The chin is pulled in and the head and eyes are to the front; and
- g. Remain silent and motionless. The eyes do not move.

Parade Rest

Parade Rest is a modified position of Attention. It is more formal than restful. Parade Rest is a two-part command: *Parade* is the preparatory command and *Rest* is the command of execution.

On the command of execution *Rest*, the militiamen will:

- a. Move the left foot approximately 10 inches to the left of the right foot;
- b. Stack the hands in the small of the back with back of the left hand centered on the belt;
- c. The right palm faces out, fingers are extended and joined, and thumbs are interlocked; and
- d. Remain silent and motionless. The eyes do not move.

Stand At Ease

Stand At Ease is a position that helps facilitate communications when the commander wishes to impart brief instructions. Stand At Ease is a two-part command: *Stand At* is the preparatory command, and *Ease* is the command of execution. On the command of execution *Ease*, the

militiamen will execute Parade Rest, except the militiamen will move head and eyes to follow the person who gave the command.

At Ease

At Ease the most commonly used rest position. The command is a combined command, with the preparatory command and command of execution given together: *At Ease*.

On the command *At Ease*, the militiamen will:

- a. Move the left foot about 10 inches to the left of the right foot;
- b. Stack the hands behind the back in a relaxed position, right hand on top, palm facing out;
- c. Interlock the thumbs, remain standing and silent; and
- d. Limited movement is allowed, but the right foot remains planted in place.

Rest

Rest is the most relaxed drill position. The command is simply *Rest*. On the command of *Rest*, the militiamen must keep his right foot in place, but he may eat, drink, smoke, or speak quietly unless otherwise directed.

When commander wishes to end the Rest session, he will command *At Ease*. That is the signal to put up food, drinks, etc. and prepare for formal activity. The commander will give the troops adequate time to prepare before giving the command *Attention*.

About Face

About Face is a command used to turn stationary troops 180 degrees. About Face is a two-part command, with *About* being the preparatory command and *Face* being the command of execution.

On the command of execution *Face*, militiamen will:

- a. Place the right toe behind and slightly to the left of the left heel; and
- b. Pivot 180 degrees to the right, keeping the arms close to the sides.

This is a two-count movement. Count one is placement of the right toe behind the left heel; count two is the pivot. When done correctly, the militiamen will finish at the position of Attention.

Note: Correct placement of the right toe is the key to this movement. If you do not end up at the position of Attention when the movement is complete, experiment with toe placement. Once you find the correct placement, practice to develop muscle memory.

Hand Salute

The command for a hand salute is *Present Arms*. *Present* is the preparatory command and *Arms* is the command of execution. Present Arms is a one-count movement.

On the command of execution *Arms*, a militiamen wearing headgear with a visor will:

- a. Raise the right hand sharply, fingers extended and joined, palm down, placing the tip of forefinger on the visor slightly to the right of the right eye;
- b. The hand, wrist, and forearm will be straight from the tip of the fingers to the point of the elbow;
- c. The elbow is inclined slightly forward, and the upper arm will be horizontal to the ground; and
- d. The outer edge of the palm is canted slightly down.

When the militiamen is wearing no headgear, or headgear without a visor, the forefinger of the right hand will be placed slightly to the right of the right eyebrow. When a militiamen is wearing eyeglasses and no headgear, the right index finger is placed at the joint of the temple piece.

The command to lower the salute is *Order Arms*. *Order* is the preparatory command and *Arms* is the command of execution.

On the command of execution *Arms*, the militiamen will lower the right hand directly, returning to the position of Attention.

Note: A sharp salute speaks to a militiaman's professionalism. Practice in front of a mirror.

SECTION 4: BASIC FORMATIONS

Fall In/Fall Out

Troops usually assemble in a *line formation* where militiamen are arranged in one or more ranks (lines) facing the commander. A rank consists of up 8-12 militiamen standing abreast of each other.

To assemble a group of militiamen into a formation, the command is *Fall In*. It is given as a combined command. Upon hearing the command *Fall In*, militiamen will double-time to their position in the formation.

The first rank (first squad) Falls In as follows:

- a. The right flank person on the first rank is the anchor. He positions himself so that the unit, when assembled, will be three steps in front of and centered on the commander;
- b. The anchor comes to the position of Attention and raises his left arm horizontally to shoulder level, palm down, fingers extended and joined. His head and eyes are to the front;
- c. The second person positions himself so that his right shoulder touches the anchor's outstretched fingertip, turning his head to the right and aligning himself with the anchor. At the same time, he raises his left arm to shoulder level, palm down, fingers extended and joined;
- d. As soon as the second person positions himself with the correct lateral distance, he turns head and eyes to the front and assumes the position of Attention. The anchor drops his left arm; and
- e. All members of the first rank will establish their positions in a similar fashion, dropping their arms and assuming the position of Attention as soon as alignment is established.

The second squad executes in essentially the same manner, except:

- a. The right flank person (squad leader) of the second rank positions himself directly behind the first squad leader at an approximate distance of 36 inches. This distance is determined by visual estimation. The squad leader DOES NOT lift his arm to estimate distance;
- b. All squad members position themselves directly behind the corresponding member of the first squad. This is called "covering." They DO NOT lift their left arms; and
- c. They glance to the right to ensure lateral alignment, then assume the position of Attention.

Additional squads execute in the same manner as the second squad.

To dismiss the formation, the command is *Fall Out*. Upon hearing the command *Fall Out*, those in formation are immediately dismissed to go about their assigned duties.

Positions of Key Personnel in a Line Formation

The formation is initially convened ("called") by a senior enlisted person, usually the First Sergeant or Sergeant Major. When formed, the unit will be positioned three steps in front of, and centered on, the NCO who gave the command to *Fall In*.

Once the unit is formed, the NCO will about face and await the commanding officer. The officer will approach from the *left flank* and position himself three steps in front of the NCO. The NCO will salute and report “Sir, all present and accounted for.” The commander will return the salute and instruct the NCO to “Post.”

The NCO will drop his salute, face to the right as in marching, and *incline around the right flank* of the formation. He will assume his post one step to the rear of the formation and centered.

When the commander has finished addressing the troops, he may dismiss the formation or he may return control to the senior NCO. If turning the formation over to the NCO, the commander will call “First Sergeant (or Sergeant Major).” The NCO will come to attention, face to the right as in marching, *incline around the right side* of the formation, and present himself three steps in front of the commander.

Salutes are exchanged. The commander will face to the right as in marching and depart in the direction of the *left flank* of the formation. Once the commander has cleared the area, the NCO will about face and dismiss the formation.

Note: Officers approach and depart the formation from the left side, and NCOs travel around the right flank. When the officer is in charge, his position is six steps in front of, and centered on, the formation; the NCO’s position is one step to the rear of the formation and centered. When the officer is not present and the NCO is in charge, his position is three steps in front of the formation and centered.

Breaking Ranks

Breaking Ranks is a procedure followed when a militiamen is called out of the formation to report to the commander in front of the formation. This is frequently done when the commander wishes to commend or decorate a militiamen.

The commander will direct, “Private _____, front and center.” The militiamen will:

- a. Come to the position of Attention and respond “Here, Sir (or Here, First Sergeant);”
- b. Take one 15-inch backward step;
- c. Rotate head to the Right and Left as in Marching and exit the formation in the shortest and most direct manner;
- d. Once clear of the formation, march in the most direct manner to a position two steps in front of and centered on the commander; and
- e. When the commander dismisses the militiamen, the militiamen will Face to the Right (Left) as in Marching and move back to his place in formation. He will follow the same route as he used to exit the formation.

Dress Right Dress

Dress Right Dress allows the commander to perfect the alignment of the troops in a line formation. It is frequently ordered immediately after Open Ranks March to finalize preparation for inspection. Dress Right Dress is a two-part command: *Dress Right* is the preparatory command and *Dress* is the command of execution.

On the command of execution, militiamen will:

- a. Except for the right flank person in each rank, all will turn their head and eyes to the right, correcting their lateral alignment as needed; and
- b. Except for the left flank person in each rank, all will lift their left arms laterally to shoulder level, palms down, fingers and thumb extended and joined.

Note: The first rank will establish the lateral distance between militiamen just as is done in Fall In. Those in the second, third, and fourth ranks will raise their arms for uniformity of appearance, but they will cover the person in front of them.

The commander may further check each rank for alignment, making corrections as needed. When satisfied, he will command *Ready Front*. *Ready* is the preparatory command and *Front* is the command of execution. On the command of execution *Front*, troops will drop their arms, face to the front, and return to the position of Attention.

SECTION 5: IN RANKS INSPECTION PROCEDURES

There are several ways to conduct an in-ranks inspection. The following is a simple approach, handled by one inspector, and suited for a platoon-sized unit of up to 40 troops in a line formation. Depending on the number of personnel, they may be arranged in up to four ranks.

The inspector (either officer or NCO) will order the unit to Open Ranks March and Dress Right Dress. Once he is satisfied with alignment, the inspector:

- a. Faces to the Half-Left As in Marching, and marches to a point 15 inches in front of, and centered on, the first squad leader. Orders “Second, third, and fourth squads, At Ease;”
- b. Inspects the front of the first squad leader, moving only head and eyes;
- c. Takes a short step to the half-left to inspect the militiaman's right side, then steps back to center;
- d. Takes a short step to the half-right to inspect the militiaman's left side, the steps back to center; and

e. Faces to the right as in marching, takes two short steps, halts in front of the second militiamen, and executes a Left Face, and inspects the second militiamen, etc. and so on down the first rank.

When the last militiamen in the first squad has been inspected, the inspector will:

- a. Face to the Right As in Marching and walk around the last man to inspect the squad from the rear; and
- b. Orders “Second Squad, Attention” and continues to inspect the first squad from the rear, moving from man to man.

When the entire first squad has been inspected from the rear, the inspector will:

- a. Position himself 15 inches in front of, and centered on, the second squad leader and order “First Squad, At Ease;” and
- b. Inspect the second squad in the same manner as the first squad, and so on until all squads have been inspected.

When all personnel have been inspected, the inspector marches back to his original post in the most direct manner. He will halt, face to the left, and call the unit to Attention. He will then order Close Ranks March.

During the inspection, the inspector should check the obvious uniform and grooming items for every militiamen. This includes:

- a. General hygiene and appearance;
- b. Placement of all patches, tapes, and insignia;
- c. Boots and boot lacing; and
- d. Buttons and fasteners.

The inspector should randomly check:

- a. Medical Forms and ID cards; and
- b. Belts, to ensure that the tongue of the belt is no longer than two inches.

The inspector may also ask pertinent questions to determine the militiaman's knowledge and readiness.

Note: For detailed information on grooming standards, inspectors should consult Army Regulation 670-1, Chapter 3.